

ATL SOUL

THE VELVET LaRUE STORY

"If Dreamgirls and When They See Us had a baby, and that baby was raised by Prince in 1979 Atlanta."

Genre: Soul-Music Biopic / Social-Issue Thriller

Format: 90-minute MOW

Tone: Grit and glitter. Cinéma vérité meets music video surrealism.

WELCOME TO ATLANTA, 1979

Sweat, Sequins, and Segregation



Auburn Avenue

Storefront churches compete with record shops. The heartbeat of Black Atlanta where gospel meets soul.

Peachtree Plaza Hotel

70 floors of unspoken "whites-only." Glass towers reflecting a divided city's contradictions.



The Divide

Soul vs. silence. Vinyl vs. violence. A city on the edge of change, waiting for a voice to break through.

Where music becomes revolution, and revolution becomes music

WHO IS VELVET LaRUE?

The Voice They Tried to Erase



Look

Gap-toothed, hoop earrings, Stax jacket over bare skin. Raw beauty that commands attention.

Sound

Honey cut with gravel. A voice that can heal hearts and start revolutions.

Weapon

Writes her best songs in withdrawal. Pain becomes power, struggle becomes soul.

"She didn't need a permit to start a riot."

SOUNDTRACK OF A REVOLUTION

Original Songs + Needle Drops



🎵 Original Songs

🎵 "Velvet Moon"

🎵 "Dirty Hymn #1"

🎵 "Take-Back"

🎵 "Peachtree Blues"

🎯 Needle Drops

▶ Curtis Mayfield's "Pusherman"

▶ Funkadelic

▶ Aretha Franklin

▶ Original gospel choruses

Music drives the narrative and emotional impact of the film

THIS AIN'T JUST MUSIC

A Civil Rights Reckoning in Sequin Drag

Cultural Ownership

Velvet vs. the label (Royal Crown Records). The battle for artistic control mirrors the broader struggle for Black economic empowerment in the post-civil rights era.

Reclamation through Performance

Music becomes the weapon of choice for reclaiming power, voice, and identity. Velvet's rooftop performance transforms personal trauma into collective liberation.

Inspired by Real-Life Battles

Megan Thee Stallion

Legal battle with 1501 Certified Entertainment over contract terms

Prince

Decades-long fight with Warner Bros. for ownership of masters

Taylor Swift

Re-recording albums to regain control after masters were sold

Comp Titles

Dreamgirls

Cadillac Records

Judas and the Black Messiah

"When the system steals your voice, you take it back with a song."

CASTING LOOKBOOK

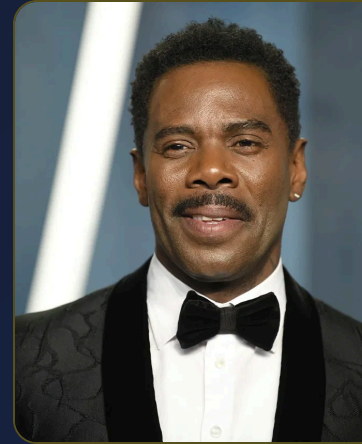
Period-Perfect Talent



Velvet LaRue

Coco Jones / Janelle Monáe

Seeking an actress with powerful vocal ability, raw emotional range, and commanding stage presence. Must embody both vulnerability and fierce determination.



Duke LaRue (father)

Colman Domingo

A preacher with secrets, trying to save his daughter's body and soul. Needs to convey complex moral conflict and powerful gospel vocals.



C.C. Cole (label boss)

Sterling K. Brown / Lakeith Stanfield

Charismatic but ruthless record executive who discovers Velvet. Requires an actor who can balance charm with menace.

Supporting Cast

Lil' Bit (best friend): Danielle Brooks

Jonah Blue (ally/engineer): Ben Platt or David Corenswet

Ensemble: Seeking authentic 1970s Atlanta types with musical abilities for church choir, club scenes, and protest moments.

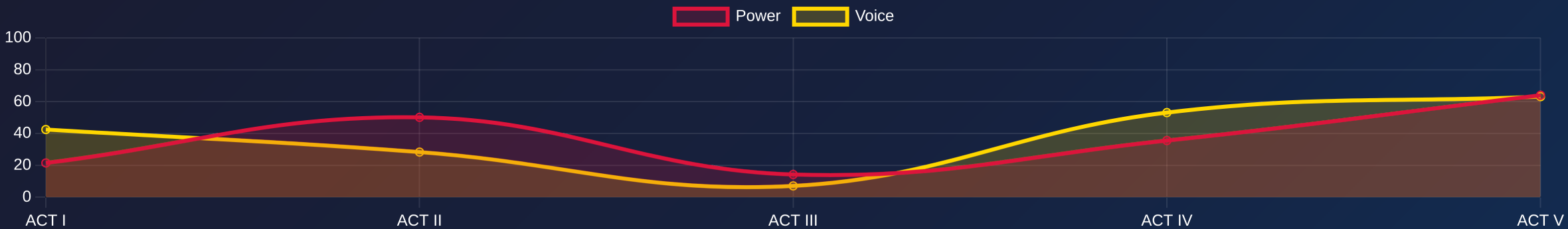
Casting Vision

Prioritizing actors with musical abilities who can authentically embody the soul, grit, and complexity of 1979 Atlanta. All leads must be able to perform live vocals for key musical moments.

5-ACT CHARACTER BEATS

Velvet: From Victim to Vanguard

★ Velvet's Journey



ACT I

Hungry, gifted, raw. Signs away ownership.

ACT II

Addicted and adored. Fame isolates.

ACT III

Betrayed. Loses everything.

ACT IV

Withdraws. Regains voice. Tapes "Take-Back."

ACT V

Hijacks rooftop. Starts revolution.

🏠 Duke: From Shame to Salvation

A preacher with secrets, Duke LaRue struggles with his daughter's secular success while hiding his own past as a soul musician. When Velvet hits rock bottom, Duke must confront his own demons to help her recover. He ultimately sings her through withdrawal, using the very music he once rejected, finding redemption in the process of saving his daughter.

"Their parallel journeys mirror Atlanta's own transformation"

MARKETING HOOKS

Compelling Audience Engagement Strategies

“ Taglines

“Her voice was stolen. Her city was divided. One rooftop changed everything.”

“She walked so SZA and Megan could run.”

🎬 Promo Moments



Rooftop Performance - Climactic scene with Atlanta skyline and fireworks backdrop.



Baptism Scene - Velvet leads diverse crowd into whites-only hotel pool.



Merch Tie-In



Vinyl Re-release: Velvet Moon: The Lost Tapes

Limited edition vinyl featuring original songs plus bonus tracks.



Vintage T-shirts & Remixed Trap-Soul Soundtrack

Authentic 1979 concert merch and modern interpretations by Atlanta artists.

Social Media Strategy



Campaign: #VelvetRevolution connects film to current music ownership battles.



Partnerships: Contemporary artists discussing their ownership journeys.



WHY NOW?

The Perfect Cultural Moment

Cultural Relevance

Ownership, addiction, and artistic erasure are hotter-than-ever topics. From Taylor Swift's re-recordings to Britney's conservatorship battle, audiences are hungry for stories about artists reclaiming their power.

Cross-Promo Potential

 Music brands partnerships

 BET, Lifetime, OWN networks

 Soundtrack and vinyl releases

Market Demand

Streaming platforms are actively seeking **diverse, music-driven content** that combines entertainment with social impact. Success of "Judas and the Black Messiah" proves audiences want substantive stories.

Streaming Gold

Social impact + visual spectacle = streaming/event TV gold. Period authenticity, musical performances, and contemporary relevance create multiple viewing experiences for diverse audiences.

The Bottom Line

"ATL SOUL" arrives at the intersection of cultural conversation and commercial opportunity, delivering both entertainment value and meaningful social commentary.

BET+

Lifetime

OWN

Netflix

Hulu

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